Prince Sultan University
College of Business Administration / Finance Department
Second Semester 2026 – 2027 (261)

INSTITUTIONAL COURSE SYLLABUS

Course Code: ECON 101	**Course Title:** Principles of Microeconomics
Course Instructor: Dr Nazia Hashmi	**Email: nhashmi@psu.edu.sa**
Office Hours: Sun & Mon **10-11 am & 3-4 pm** Please make an appointment by email.	**Course Schedule:** Section 403: 1-2 pm, UMT, G-A26/27 Section 404: 2-3 pm, UMT, G-A27 Section 405: 4-5 pm, UMT, G-A27
Credit Hours: 3	**Office Location: Building 109, 2-A37**
Co-Requisite: N/A	**Prerequisite:** -

Mission Statement

"Our mission is to provide high-quality education, research, and services in finance."

I. Course Description: This course discusses the terminology, concepts, theory, methodology, and limitations of microeconomic analysis. It provides students with a theoretical structure to analyze and understand economics as it relates to individuals and businesses and the roles of the market price system in managing the use of society's resources and in rationing available supplies. In addition, it seeks to provide students with a thorough understanding of the principles of economics that apply to the functions of individual decision makers, both consumers and producers, within the economic system. It places primary emphasis on the nature and functions of product markets and includes the study of factor markets and of the role of the government in promoting greater efficiency and equity in the economy.

II. Course Learning Outcomes: On the successful completion of this course, students will be able to demonstrate the following:

Skills	Course Learning Outcomes
Knowledge & Understanding	CLO 1: Recognize the role of scarcity, trade-off, opportunity cost, and cost-benefit analysis in economic decision-making. CLO 2: Recognize the fundamental economic theories and concepts at the micro level.
Skills	CLO 3: Perform demand and supply analysis to analyze the impact of real-world economic events on markets CLO 4: Analyze the behavior of consumers in terms of the demand for products. CLO 5: Demonstrate ability to accomplish required tasks and assignments CLO 6: Interpret basic microeconomic data

Values	

III. Tentative Weekly Course Schedule:

Week No.	Unit/ Topic	CLO (s) alignment	Student Tasks (assignments, readings, exams, quizzes, presentations, etc.…)	No. of Contact hours
1	**Chapter 1: What Is Economics?** – Definition of Economics – Two Big Economic Questions – The Economic Way of Thinking – Economics as a Social Science and Policy Tool – Economists in the Economy – Appendix	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In-class problem solving Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	3
2	**Chapter 2: The Economic Problem** – Production Possibilities and Opportunity Cost – Using Resources Efficiently – Gains from Trade – Economic Growth – Economic Coordination	**1, 2, 5**	Class Participation In-class problem solving Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	3
3	**Chapter 3: Demand and Supply** – Markets and Prices – Demand – Supply – Market Equilibrium – Predicting Changes in Price and Quantity	**3, 4, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams	6
5	**Chapter 4: Elasticity** – Price Elasticity of Demand – More Elasticities of Demand – Elasticity of Supply	**3, 4, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams	6
7	**Chapter 5: Efficiency and Equity** – Resource Allocation Methods – Benefit, Cost, and Surplus – Is the Competitive Market Efficient? – Is the Competitive Market Fair?	**1, 2, 3, 4 5, 6**	Class Participation In-class problem solving Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	3
8	**Chapter 6: Government Actions in Markets** – A Housing Market with a Rent Ceiling – A Labor Market with a Minimum Wage – Taxes – Production Quotas and Subsidies – Markets for Illegal Goods	**2, 3, 4, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	3

9	**Chapter 8: Utility and Demand** – Consumption Choices – Utility-Maximizing Choice – Predictions of Marginal Utility Theory – New Ways of Explaining Consumer Choices	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In-class problem solving Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	4
10	**Chapter 9: Possibilities, Preferences, and Choices** – Consumption Possibilities – Preferences and Indifference Curves – Predicting Consumer Choices	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In-class problem solving Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	4
12	**Chapter 11: Output and Costs** – Decision Time Frames – Short-Run Technology Constraint – Short-Run Cost	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	4
13	**Chapter 12: Perfect Competition** – What Is Perfect Competition? – The Firm's Output Decision – Output, Price, and Profit in the Short Run	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	**3**
14	**Chapter 13: Monopoly** – Monopoly and How It Arises – A Single-Price Monopoly's Output and Price Decision – Single-Price Monopoly and Competition Compared – Price Discrimination	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	**3**
15	**Chapter 14: Monopolistic Competition** – What Is Monopolistic Competition? – Price and Output in Monopolistic Competition	**1, 2, 5, 6**	Class Participation In class solving problems Homework, Quizzes, Exams, Discussion	**3**

IV. Student Assessment, Teaching Strategies & Assessment Task:

Domain	Assessment Task	Teaching Strategy
Knowledge	Quizzes and examinations	Lecture, in-class exercise
Skills	Examinations – essay type and MCQs	Application questions
Values	Assignments and attendance	Discussion

V. Course Requirements:

- **Access to MOODLE (LMS):** Students are required to access Moodle frequently to check announcements and material posted for the course, such as the syllabus, slides, assignments, online examinations, etc.
- **Quizzes:** The quizzes will be used to assess your knowledge regarding this course.
- **Majors:** The majors will assess both your understanding of the theory and the practical application of it in the field of this course.
- **Assignments:** As part of the course, you are required to submit good-quality assignments during this course; ensure that your submission of assignments is on time.
- **Class Attendance and Participation:** It is important to attend class prepared, to add to the discussion, or to complete the tasks assigned during class. Attendance will be taken every class as per PSU regulations.
- **Final Exam:** The final exam is comprehensive (All chapters covered throughout the semester) and will assess both your understanding of the theory and the practical application of it in the field of this course.

VI. Schedule of Assessment:

Assessment No.	Assessment Task	Exam Dates	Proportion of Final Assessment
1.	**QUIZ – I** ***Chapters: 1, 2***	Week No. 5 ***Date:*** *7th September 2026, Monday* ***Time:*** *12—12:30 PM— Location: TBD*	**5%**
2.	**MAJOR – I *[Unified]*** ***Chapters: 2, 3, 4***	Week No. 8 ***Date:*** *17th September 2026, Thursday* ***Time:*** *12—1 PM— Location: TBD*	**20%**
3.	**QUIZ – II** ***Chapters: 5, 6***	Week No. 10 ***Date:*** *12th October 2026, Monday* ***Time:*** *12—12:30 PM— Location: TBD*	**5%**
4.	**MAJOR – II *[Unified]*** ***Chapters: 6, 8, 9***	Week No. 12 ***Date:*** *28th October 2026, Wednesday* ***Time:*** *12-1 PM* - ***Location:*** *TBD*	**20%**
5.	**Assignments**	On-going	**5%**
6.	**Class attendance and participation**	On-going	**5%**

7.	**Final examination** ***[Unified]*** ***All Chapters***	Week No. 15 *21st November 2026, Saturday* *12:30 – 2:30 PM*	**40%**

The marks given for attendance, as mentioned in the table above, will be according to the following rubric:

50 mins lectures	
Absences	**Mark %**
1 to 5	5.0
6-7	4.0
8	3.0
9-10	2.0
11	1.0
12	DN

1 hour 15 mins lectures	
Absences	**Mark %**
1 to 3	5.0
4	4.0
5	3.0
6	2.0
7	1.0
8	DN

As you can see, the first few absences are given for "free" and do not affect the attendance grade. However, **keep in mind that ALL absences will count towards the university DN policy**.

VII. Learning Resources

A. References:

- **Required Textbook:**
  - Michael Parkin (2023) Microeconomics, 14th Edition, published by Pearson Education. ISBN 978-0-13-747079-2

- **Supplementary Sources:**
  - Campbell R. McConnell, Stanley L. Brue and Sean Masaki Flynn – Economics (2021) **22nd Edition**, McGraw-Hill Education. ISBN: 978-0-07-681974-4 (Student Edition)
  - N. G. Mankiw and M. H. Rashwan (2021). Principles of Economics, Fourth Arab World Edition (4E). Cengage Learning. ISBN 978-1-4737-0484-8.
  - http://data.worldbank.org/indicator (*World Bank*)
  - https://www.sama.gov.sa/ (*Saudi Central Bank*)

B. Facilities Required:

- Laptop or desktop with internet connection and webcam for online lectures and examinations.
- Lecture room, white/smart board, computer, and a projector for on-campus lectures.

C. Learning Management System:

PSU-EDU-HUB Platform (Moodle): It is required to make use of MOODLE. All the lecture materials, assignments, and other news will be posted on Moodle and will be announced from time to time. The students must be responsible for the materials posted. If you have any problems accessing your account, please refer to IT center at the soonest possible.

D. Writing and Tutoring Center – Students are highly advised to use the Writing and Tutoring Center's academic services by booking tutoring/writing appointments through the **booking system:** (https://psu.mywconline.net/)

VIII. Classroom Policies:

A. Academic Integrity Policy (e.g., plagiarism or dishonesty)

Plagiarism can be defined as unintentionally or deliberately using another person's writing or ideas as though they are one's own. Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to, copying another individual's work and taking credit for it, paraphrasing information from a source without proper documentation, and mixing one's own words with those of another author without attribution. In addition, buying a paper or project, or downloading a paper from the Internet, and submitting it as your own is also plagiarism. The penalty for academic dishonesty will bring course expulsion and failure, or even suspension" (Academic Integrity and Syllabus Acknowledgement Form).

All students are expected to submit their 'own' work and not the work of others.

B. Attendance Policy

Please adhere to the following guidelines:

- A student is required to attend lectures, tutorials, and laboratory sessions. If a student's absences (excused or unexcused) **exceed 25%, i.e., 12 absences for 50-minute classes, and 8 absences for 1 hour 15-minute classes,** the student will be barred from continuing the course, denied entrance to the respective final examination, and given the grade (DN) in the course.

- Not receiving a warning regarding the absence hours does not exempt the student from being denied if his/her absences reach the maximum limit.

- If a student receives a grade of (DN) in a course due to the number of absences in the lectures and practical lessons specified for the course, whether these absences were excused or unexcused, then the (DN) cannot be removed.

- No make-up exams will be allowed except for university-accepted documents. (Refer to the student regulation handbook for further details.)

- **Students are not allowed to re-enter the classroom once they leave**. This means there are no toilet or coffee breaks unless a medical excuse is provided (please talk to me privately if that is the case).

- Given that all points above apply, **if a student is not present in the classroom while taking attendance, the student will be marked absent for that class**.

C. Homework Submission Policy

- Any unacceptable delay in assignment submission will result in a deduction of 1 mark for every day of delay.

- Homework submission will be through Edu-hub (LMS). You must submit your work before the deadline stipulated; otherwise, a mark of zero will be given for that assignment.

D. AI usage policy

Acceptable Content Percentage: The following table outlines the maximum allowed percentage of AI-generated content in academic work:

Stakeholder	Work Type	Max AI Content
Graduate Students	Master's Theses	≤25%
Graduate Students	PhD Dissertations	≤20%
Graduate Students	Research Papers	≤20%
Graduate Students	Coursework	≤30%
Undergraduates	Capstone Projects	≤30%
Undergraduates	Research Papers/Essays	≤30%
Undergraduates	Lab Reports	≤30%
Undergraduates	Group Projects	≤30%
Undergraduates	Coursework	≤30%

Thank you!